By then, the story had become a sensation in Tamil Nadu. The staff of *India Today*'s Madras bureau were scared to go to work, fearing an attack by the LTTE on the office. The head office from Delhi intervened and made them feel safe. Yet, the Madras bureau had two police constables for security for the next few weeks.

Amid all this, two entities registered their disapproval of the story. SIT boss Kaarthikeyan thought *India Today* had published 'too much too soon'. He had to face awkward questions from other publications about how the SIT was favouring a particular magazine with so much exclusive material. Charges of favouritism were levelled against him. The editor of a Delhi-based daily taunted Kaarthikeyan in his Sunday column that it was not clear if the SIT chief was 'working for a magazine' or for the CBI. Kaarthikeyan stopped taking Anirudhya's calls. When reporters questioned him about 'why the SIT was giving *India Today* preferential treatment', he flatly denied any such thing. Some photojournalists asked Kaarthikeyan to clarify why one of their profession's stalwarts, Subha Sundaram, a man of repute, was getting dragged into the case. The SIT chief, in response, observed that a lot of the information printed in *India Today* had been 'a reporter's imagination'. But within four days of *India Today*'s story, Sundaram was arrested, belying Kaarthikeyan's claim that most of the *India Today* story, including that Sundaram's studio was a hub of LTTE activities, were 'a reporter's imagination'. Two others—photographer Ramamurthy and a colleague Vijay Sadasiva, who had been sent by Sundaram to the blast site to look for the missing camera—were also arrested. Why did the SIT arrest people earlier accused in the story if they were innocent and their role in the operation was 'a reporter's imagination'? However, Kaarthikeyan refused to comment on their arrest in spite of repeated queries from the media. The arrest of Sundaram, a giant in the journalism world, had put a lid on the trolling.